Mini-Activity: "AI on Trial – The Ethical Dilemma"
Requirements:

Learning Objectives

Students will:

1. Apply ethical reasoning to a real AI dilemma.
2. Identify stakeholder viewpoints and conflicting values.
3. Reach a collective ethical verdict under time pressure.

Scenario: "The Predictive Student AI"

A university adopts an AI system that predicts which students are likely to fail or drop out, using data such as grades, attendance, background, and even sentiment from discussion forums.

The AI seems to help improve retention — but reports show that students from certain ethnic and low-income backgrounds are flagged as "high risk" far more often, and no one knows exactly how the algorithm works.
Recently, a data leak exposed hundreds of student profiles, sparking outrage.

The university must now decide whether to pause, continue, or revise the system.

Setup

1. **Dividing the class into 3 groups:**
    - **Group A – Developers / Tech Company**
    - **Group B – Students / Public Advocates**
    - **Group C – University Board (jury and decision-makers)**
2. Skim the scenario and note their key arguments or concerns.

Activity

Activity	**Description**
Stakeholder Arguments	Each group presents their viewpoint in **3 minutes**. Encourage quick, passionate arguments. The "jury" (Group C) may ask one short question after each.
Open Rebuttal	One quick round: Groups A and B get 2 minutes each to respond or counter.

Activity	Description
Verdict & Ethical Reflection	Group C deliberates and announces their verdict: Continue / Pause / Ban. They must justify it using at least **two ethical principles** (e.g., fairness, accountability, privacy).

- What ethical trade-offs appeared?
- Who should hold the most responsibility — developers, institutions, or regulators?
- What could make this system more trustworthy? |

Debriefing

1. Did any argument change your mind during the debate?
2. Which ethical principle felt most violated?
3. What real-world parallels can you see (e.g., credit scoring, recruitment AI, predictive policing)?